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Government in Zazzau 1800-1950

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The Mallawa still being discredited by the events of Sidi's reign, and the Katsinawa being as weak in 1863 as they were three years before, only the Bornawa could furnish a successor to Audusallami. Of the Bornawa candidates, the Madaki Audullahi, who was the son of Hamada, and had demonstrated his ability during the preceding reign, was clearly the strongest candidate. The electoral council of Zaria recommended Abdullahi's succession, and the Sultan of Sokoto agreed, sending his Waziri to crown Abdullahi at Zaria. On his appointment the new king was instructed that the Sultan expected the Mallawa candidate Abubakar to retain the office of Wombai. Abdullahi had to accept this; but to nullify and isolate Abubakar he redistributed most of the other important offices among the Bornawa and their closest supporters.

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The king promoted his brother Ibiru from the position of Dan Galadima to that of Madaki, which his own accession had made vacant. Ibiru died shortly after, and Abdullahi made his own son, Yero, Madaki. He gave Hussein, another of his sons, the office of Dan Galadima. He removed Sidi's Magajin Gari, Jembari, from that office, appointing his own wife's elder brother, a *suruki*, in his stead. The king appointed his paternal uncle, Dan Kakai, to the position of Wali. Hamman, the son of Yamusa's brother, was still Galadima. The former eunuch office of Fagaci which had long been vacant was given to a Fulani client. Aliyu, a grandson of Hamada, was appointed Mardanni, and Ja'afaru, one of the ruler's sons, was appointed Makama Karami. Abdullahi appointed his mother's brother to the office of Sa'i, and after the latter's death he gave the office to this mother's brother's son, Habu, a joking relation (*abokin wasa*

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). These appointments gave the ruler undisputed control of the government, and also restored the patterns of appointment initiated by Yamusa and developed by Mommon Sani.

Abdullahi allowed the Katsinawa candidate, Aliyu, to retain the office of Iya, either to enlist their support for his rule or to identify them with that office, and thus indirectly to reduce their claims for the throne. When this Katsinawa Iya Aliyu died shortly after, Abdullahi appointed Aliyu's son, Abdurrahman (also called Abdurrahul), to succeed him. Yaji, another of the Bornawa, who was Abdullahi's grandson by his son, the Makama Ja'afaru, was given  170 the title of Sarkin Ruwa. This was the first time that any member of a dynasty had held this office. On the death of the Suleibawa Dallatu Malle, Abdullahi appointed his own ortho-cousin, Mallam, the son of Iya Atiku, in his place. Abdullahi then dismissed the Galadima Hamman on grounds of old age, and appointed Adamu instead. Adamu's father had been Musa's Galadima, and his brother was married to Abdullahi's daughter.

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